



BORDER ROADS ORGANISATION, DELHI

CONNECTING PEOPLE

The Border Roads Organisation (BRO) was set up in 1960, a decade after the People's Republic of China gobbled up Tibet. That act made neighbours, and later, for the first time, adversaries out of two ancient civilisations. Yet, the border, over which the two countries went to war two years later, was a jagged line on difficult, inhospitable terrain, which was inaccessible without roads. Only an organisation as unique as the BRO, comprising engineers drawn from the army and organised on military lines, was found up to the task. The BRO has covered areas of extreme privation and security risk where the private sector would not dare venture. It has built roads and infrastructure in Bhutan, Myanmar and in Afghanistan where its workers were killed and kidnapped. Says Lt-General A.K. Nanda, director-general, BRO, "Ever since its inception, the BRO has offered service to the nation in the cause of socio-economic development and has lent its expertise and service to the armed forces during national emergencies. It has also given aid to civil power in turbulent areas and coordinated rescue and relief measures." With infrastructure construction on the Chinese side causing concern, the Government of India has asked the BRO to build over 3,000 km of roads in five years. The wheel is turning full circle.

by Sandeep Unnikrishnan

"The BRO connects the country by building roads where none exist."

M.M. PALLAM RAJU, MINISTER OF STATE FOR DEFENCE



SUVASHIS MULLICK

BROTHERS IN ARMS: Brigadier Ram at the school

INTO THE WORLD Lt-General Mathew Thomas established an adhoc Jungle Training School at Mynkore near Jowai, Shillong, in 1967.

COUNT THEM In the past two decades, the school has also trained 1,500 personnel from 25 countries in 'small team operations'.

"We have to train to combat terrorism or end up training all our lives for a conventional war we may never fight."

BRIGADIER A.K. RAM, COMMANDANT, CIJWS